



A WAYMO in Santa Monica in May. Accidents involving Waymo vehicles tripled last year in L.A. County.

Accuser joined by an army of ‘Jane Does’

Solidarity surges for woman suing Cornell and 7 men she says sexually assaulted her.

By DEEPTI HAJELA

NEW YORK — It was one woman, then another, and another, until a trickle became a flood.

Countless women, and some men, posting on social media that they were Jane Doe, in support of a young woman using that name to file a lawsuit against Cornell University and seven fraternity members she accuses of raping her.

For many, claiming the name came along with sharing personal accounts of being sexually abused and assaulted, joining the wave of solidarity that has surged since journalists at the college’s independent student newspaper reported on the lawsuit filing late last month.

The impetus for some of those claiming the name was a desire to offer the woman some protection in this digital age, in response to those wanting to identify her real name online. They hope the flood of “I am Jane Doe” posts will confuse online algorithms.

The posts have come in all formats — video, photo, text — across the landscape of social media platforms.

The outcry reminds many of the energy at the heights of the #MeToo movement, which exploded a decade ago. Back then women posted their stories of sexual harassment and assault, as allegations surfaced against movie producer Harvey Weinstein, using the hashtag phrase, which had been introduced in that context a decade earlier.

“These moments ... are encouraging more women to speak up and tell their stories,” said Emma Davidson Tribbs, founding director of the National Women’s Defense League. “They are giving people a level of bravery and comfort to come forward and speak their truth. And they can be incredibly catalyzing for change.”

Change is what Wendy Lea Brewer wants to see, and that inspired her to post [See Cornell, A6]

More robotaxis, more crashes: A dive into data

Most crashes involving Waymos resulted in no apparent injuries

- Suspected serious injury
- Suspected minor and possible injury
- No injury



Of 485 crashes from March 1, 2023, to Aug. 3, 2026, only 166 had specific location information. Seventy-eight percent of accidents without address information occurred in the city of Los Angeles.

California Autonomous Vehicle Crash Dashboard

HAILEY WANG Los Angeles Times

By CAROLINE PETROW-COHEN

As more driverless cars hit Los Angeles streets, accidents involving them have surged.

Accidents tied to Mountain View, Calif.-based Waymo tripled last year in L.A. County as it put more robotaxis on the road. The vehicles still had relatively few incidents, and most were fender benders, according to a Times review of autonomous vehicle crash data filed with the National Highway Traffic Safety Administration.

Amazon’s Zoox already is testing its driverless vehicles in L.A., and Tesla’s Cybercab and others are expected to follow suit.

Waymo, Zoox and Cybercab operate in many cities, but California still serves as a test site for robotaxi technology, said Matthew Raifman, who studies autonomous vehicles at UC Berkeley’s Safe Transportation Research and Education Center and compiled a dashboard of robotaxi accidents using government data.

“As a testing bed place in [See Waymo, A8]



KAYLA BARTKOWSKI Los Angeles Times

CLUB founder George Jensen records audio of fowl at a wildlife reserve.

Float away on the city’s sounds

L.A.’s Field Recording Club explores and listens

By MICHELLE MADDEN

On an atypically muggy evening in Highland Park, several Angelenos sit beneath a shade sail in a parking lot behind the Bearded Beagle vintage shop on Figueroa. A pandemonium of parrots screeches by, a siren wails in the distance, a helicopter chops the air above. But these folks have their ears trained on something else. Coming from two high-performance speakers arranged before the group? The sounds of a fax machine.

The group is silent and still, reverently absorbing the mechanical chug of this nearly outmoded office machine like Hollywood Bowl-goers taking in Joshua Bell. When the recording ends, everyone claps enthusiastically.

This is a listening session hosted by the Los Angeles Field Recording Club.

Field recording is most simply defined as recording sounds outside a controlled [See Sounds, A5]

Trump visits to red states signal midterm worry

Polls show he’s a liability in close races, so he rallies his base on safer terrain.

By ANA CEBALLOS

DURANT, Okla. — David Coleman doesn’t know much about the Republican candidates who are running in November. But he knows President Trump, and he trusts that the president won’t steer him wrong.

The 54-year-old Oklahoman made his way to Trump’s midterm rally in Durant on Thursday planning to support whomever Trump brought onstage with him.

“I am going to ask ChatGPT what their name is and vote for them,” Coleman said as he and thousands of others waited for the president to appear.

Trump is focusing on voters such as Coleman — who are fiercely loyal to the president but only loosely attached to the rest of the Republican ticket — in the final stretch before the Nov. 3 election.

Rather than prioritizing visits to battleground dis-

tricts, which will decide which party controls Congress, Trump is rallying in Republican strongholds such as Texas, Oklahoma and Alabama, betting that his presence will be enough to energize a base that may be thinking about sitting out the election because his name isn’t on the ballot.

In Oklahoma, Trump told the crowd to imagine he is on the ballot because the future of his “America first” agenda depends on Republicans getting out to vote. He then urged them to vote for GOP candidates such as Senate candidates Ken Paxton of Texas and Kevin Hern of Oklahoma.

“You have to get out and vote,” Trump said. “You can’t assume they are going to win.”

The red-state itinerary is a departure from what Trump initially promised to do in the 30 days leading up to the midterms. At a Rose Garden dinner with Republican lawmakers last month, he pledged to campaign in the country’s 35 most competitive districts. But in many of those races, the president is proving to be a political liability as his approval dwindles, even [See Trump, A4]

Coal project may be bigger, dirtier

Oakland terminal would be larger and more polluting than planned, report says.

By HAYLEY SMITH

A controversial planned coal export facility in California backed by President Trump may be far dirtier than locals have been led to believe, new documents show.

Widespread opposition has prevented any new coal export facility on the West Coast until now.

If it is built, more than 13 million tons of coal will be shipped each year from interior states to the West Gateway terminal in Oakland and stored in enormous open-air piles before being sent overseas, according to a recent report prepared for potential investors. That’s despite previous promises

by project developers to build a modern, fully enclosed facility that will limit dangerous dust exposure to the surrounding community.

The site is the Oakland Bulk and Oversized Terminal, a decommissioned Army base near the Port of Oakland run by developer Phil Tagami, who has been trying for years to turn it into a marine shipping terminal. Tagami did not respond to requests for comment.

It would be the largest coal export site on the U.S. West Coast, transporting coal to Japan, South Korea, Taiwan, Vietnam and Malaysia, according to the Trump administration. The president announced a \$75-million investment in the project in June, about a third of its estimated cost, although some figures are much higher.

California spent decades moving away from coal, and [See Coal, A5]

Voices PATT MORRISON COLUMNIST

The winding history of our GLDN ST8 PL8S

Your answer, please — and no going out to the garage and peeking:

What are the colors of the California license plate?

Just hazard a guess. You must see them a gazillion times a day.

Fine. They’re blue on white. But you could have said gold on black, or even red on white, and you’d have been right.

Ever since California issued its first license plates, in 1914, it’s been trying to keep up with our passion for automobiles.

We now stand at a smidge over 39 million Californians and a smidge over 36 million registered vehicles. Even AI can’t speculate on how many cars have rolled over the roads here in the decades since 1914, but the state has been ever harder pressed to keep changing plate colors and numbers and letters to match those numbers and to dodge any duplication.

And now the DMV has made its latest switcheroo. Since 1980, regular plates have been constructed as number-letter-letter-number-number-number. That entire combination has now run out, so California license plates began this year using number-number-number-letter-letter-letter-number.

Oh for those simpler days — like 1905, when California first required “motor cars” to be registered, but didn’t issue license plates. Drivers sometimes made their own, carved from wood, stamped onto metal, the numbers mounted on screens, or painted onto boards.

In 1914, the state realized it had better get a handle on this, a way to distinguish all of those thousands of black Ford Model Ts from one another, and to put some dough in the state’s road repair kitty while they were at it.

Voila, universal regis- [See Morrison, A6]

Rams rally to stun Eagles

L.A. overcomes a host of miscues to outscore Philadelphia 14-0 in the 4th quarter for much-needed win. **SPORTS, D1**

Culver CityBus driver mourned

Community gathers to say goodbye to Bruce Rodriguez. A suspect in his fatal shooting is in custody. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Translating a mogul’s rebrand

After naming his new empire Skydance, David Ellison’s message is clear: Hollywood is his. **ENTERTAINMENT, E1**

Weather
Very hot.
L.A. Basin: 103/79. **B6**

